
CHURN IS DEAD

The Signed-and-Forgotten Audit

A diagnostic tool for CS teams

Half your enterprise book may carry a price-adjustment clause you've never collected. This audit scores your portfolio on the forgotten uplift — the compounding revenue you're contractually owed — and hands you a leadership-ready number.

Scoring: Rate each item 1-5. 1 = not happening, 5 = embedded in operations.

Created by: Kuber Sethi

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SECTION 1

1. Find the Clause

You cannot enforce a lever you can't locate. Most teams discover they genuinely don't know which contracts carry an escalator — that ignorance is the first finding.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Contract coverage	Every enterprise logo has been read for commercial terms, not just kickoff scope	Nobody knows how many contracts contain price-adjustment language
Clause identification	CPI pegs, fixed uplifts, auto-escalators, and renewal-rate provisions are each flagged by type	Escalators sit unread in PDFs named 'Signed - Final - FINAL v3'
Trigger mechanics captured	For each clause you know what moves price and what triggers it	The mechanism is unknown; teams assume without reading
System of record	Clause language is tagged and searchable in a CLM (Ironclad, DocuSign, Salesforce objects)	Commercial terms live in shared drives and three-year-old email threads
Notice window logged	Each escalator's notice window (60/90 days) is recorded against the renewal date	No one has identified that notice windows even exist

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
% of enterprise contracts read for commercial terms	1-5
Escalator existence known per logo (yes/no captured)	1-5
Clause language searchable in a system of record	1-5
Notice window documented for each escalator	1-5

Your Score: ____ / 5

SECTION 2

2. Compound the Gap, Honestly

The value isn't the arithmetic — it's making the cost of dormancy visceral. Modeled against notice reality, the number splits into what you can still recover and what you've already forfeited.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Life-of-contract modeling	Uplift is compounded over the full contract horizon, not just next year in isolation	Only next year's increase is estimated, understating the real gap
Recoverable vs forfeited split	Number is split into recoverable (windows open) and forfeited (windows lapsed)	One blended figure that can't be acted on or defended
Honest recovery boundaries	Forfeited uplift flagged to show cost of dormancy, not to invoice retroactively	Assumption you can backdate and bill prior missed years
Portfolio roll-up	A single 'forgotten uplift' number rolls up across all accounts	Numbers live per-account with no leadership-ready total
Compounding done correctly	Compounding math is accurate and defensible under scrutiny	Inflated or hand-wavy figures that collapse in a leadership review

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
Uplift modeled over full contract life, not one year	1-5
Recoverable and forfeited amounts separated	1-5
Portfolio-level forgotten uplift number exists	1-5
Math is defensible and honest about recovery limits	1-5

Your Score: ____ / 5

SECTION 3

3. Sequence the Ask

Enforce where it's safest first. Stable-sponsor renewals with open notice windows carry the least relationship risk — touch net-new expansion only after the owned money is collected.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Renewal-first prioritization	Escalators enforced on renewals before any net-new expansion motion	Team grinds an expansion cycle while the signed escalator sits unenforced
Sponsor stability screen	Accounts scored on sponsor stability before enforcing the clause	Enforcement attempted blindly, including on shaky relationships
Window-based sequencing	Accounts prioritized by which notice windows close soonest	No sequencing; windows lapse while lower-priority work continues
Collect-before-earn discipline	You collect owned money first, then earn the money you don't own	Expansion is the first conversation; the owned uplift is never raised

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
Renewals with escalators prioritized over expansion	1-5
Sponsor stability assessed before enforcing	1-5
Accounts sequenced by closing notice windows	1-5
Owned revenue collected before net-new is pursued	1-5

Your Score: ____ / 5

SECTION 4

4. Build the Notification Play

Most escalators are conditional on notice — miss the window and you may waive the increase entirely. A non-negotiable notice motion ensures the clause never goes dormant again.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Notice as workflow step	Renewal notice is a fixed step in the workflow, not a thing someone might remember	Notice depends on an individual CSM recalling a clause
Window tracking automation	Notice dates trigger alerts ahead of the required window on every account	Windows lapse silently and the right to the increase is waived
Standardized notice motion	A lightweight, repeatable notice template and cadence exists	Every notice is improvised, inconsistent, or skipped
Escalator as renewal default	The escalator is carried as a default at renewal, not an afterthought	Renewals process at prior price because no one flagged the clause
Ownership and accountability	A named owner is accountable for every notice window landing on time	No one owns notice; misses are discovered after the fact

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
Notice is an embedded workflow step, not a memory task	1-5
Automated alerts fire before each notice window	1-5
Standard notice template and cadence in use	1-5
Escalator carried as renewal default with named owner	1-5

Your Score: ____ / 5

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Your Scorecard

Dimension	Your Score	Max
1. 1. Find the Clause	_____	5
2. 2. Compound the Gap, Honestly	_____	5
3. 3. Sequence the Ask	_____	5
4. 4. Build the Notification Play	_____	5
TOTAL	_____	20

Total Score	Assessment	What It Means
16-20	Uncuttable	Embedded, measurable, strategically irreplaceable.
12-15	Defensible	Solid but gaps remain. Focus on lowest dimension.
8-11	Vulnerable	Real risk ahead. Treat as urgent.
4-7	Critical	Cannot survive scrutiny. Major changes needed.

What to do next: Take your lowest-scoring section and build a 30-day action plan. One at a time. Then share this with leadership -- not to ask permission, but to show you know where the gaps are.

The forgotten uplift is the money you only had to earn once.

-- Kuber

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